

MANDAR DEODHAR

A COMPETITIVE SPIRIT
The Create in India Challenge (CIC)

32
THE NUMBER OF 'CHALLENGES' CONDUCTED IN A WIDE ARRAY OF CREATIVE DISCIPLINES

100,000
APPROXIMATE NUMBER OF REGISTRATIONS RECEIVED FOR THE CONTESTS, WHICH INCLUDED OVER 1,100 INTERNATIONAL PARTICIPANTS FROM 60 COUNTRIES

135
NUMBER OF GOLD, SILVER AND BRONZE HONOURS AWARDED ON MAY 2 AT THE JIO WORLD CENTRE

WHEN KUSHAGRA TIWARI, 21, A FILMMAKING GRADUATE BASED IN GHAZIABAD, boarded a plane for the first time to attend the World Audio Visual Entertainment Summit (WAVES) from May 1-4 in Mumbai, he had little idea that he was going to come back with memories of one of the most defining experiences in his life. Receiving the Create in India Challenge (CIC) award in the Travel India category of reel-making, Tiwari, a content creator and aspiring actor, was euphoric and told Aamir Khan, from whom he received the award, that five years down the line, they would work together in a film. "I manifested it for myself," says an elated Tiwari. Aamir was impressed enough with the young man's confidence to ask him his name and say that he'd remember his prophecy. "What I most like about the CIC awards was there was no criteria for how many followers you have on social media; it's all about the content," says Tiwari. "I have just 4,500 followers, but my confidence has soared." What the award has also done is convince his parents, who were clueless about his work and concerned about his future, that their son is alright. "Now they don't ask questions," says Tiwari.

Tiwari's was one of the hundreds of stories of jubilation that emerged from the CIC, a flagship initiative of WAVES—organised by the Union ministry of information and broadcasting—which brought together creators across age, geography and disciplines. To ensure that CIC had maximum reach, the I&B ministry collaborated with the India Today Group and leading industry bodies such as the India Cellular & Electronics Association (ICEA), the Esports Federation of India, the Indian Digital Gaming Society (IDGS), the Indian Music Industry (IMI), the Indian Comics Association (ICA), the Advertising Agencies Association of India (AAAI) and the Media & Entertainment Association of India (MEAI), among others, to get participation for the 32 'challenges', or contests, covering a wide range of disciplines—from animation and gaming to VFX, XR (extended reality), digital music, comics and films. The result was over 100,000 submissions from 60 countries for 47 categories.

> **"WITH THIS INITIATIVE, YOU STEP INTO A WORLD OF NEW OPPORTUNITIES. WE ARE LAUNCHING AN INDIAN INSTITUTE OF CREATIVE TECHNOLOGY. IT WILL BE LIKE AN IIT BUT FOR TRAINING IN CREATIVITY, TO BUILD A FOUNDATION FOR INNOVATION AND EXPRESSION"**
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> **ASHWINI VAISHNAW**
> *Union Minister of information and Broadcasting*